



BOULDER VALLEY
SCHOOL DISTRICT

Board of Education | October 24, 2023

Open Enrollment Policy

JECC & JECC - R

Colorado School Choice Law

- Since 1990, Colorado law has provided the right for students to seek enrollment in particular programs or schools within their school districts and for nonresident students to apply in particular programs or schools within such school district without paying tuition. C.R.S. § 22-36-101
- Subject to available space, teaching staff and program availability



Elements of OE Policies & Regulations

- High Quality Education Programs
- Space Limitations
- School of Attendance
- Transportation Responsibility
- Special Programs
- Application Process and Deadlines
- Random Selection Lottery
- Preschool
- District Preference and Specific School Level Criteria
- Waitlist Procedures



Key Provisions of BVSD's JECC & JECC-R

- Centralized OE application lottery process
- District establishes seven district-wide preferences; seven non-charter schools have special preferences; three charter schools have special preferences
- Upon open enrollment, the school becomes the “school of attendance” through the highest grade offered at the school.
- OE enrollment does not include transportation
- Students with Disabilities have the same opportunity to open enroll as their typical peers. If a lottery seat is given, then the School District will convene as necessary an IEP team to determine whether the selected school can deliver FAPE

JECC-R

[J](#) STUDENTS

File: JECC-R (pdf)
Revised: November 1, 2021, November 8, 2022

OPEN ENROLLMENT

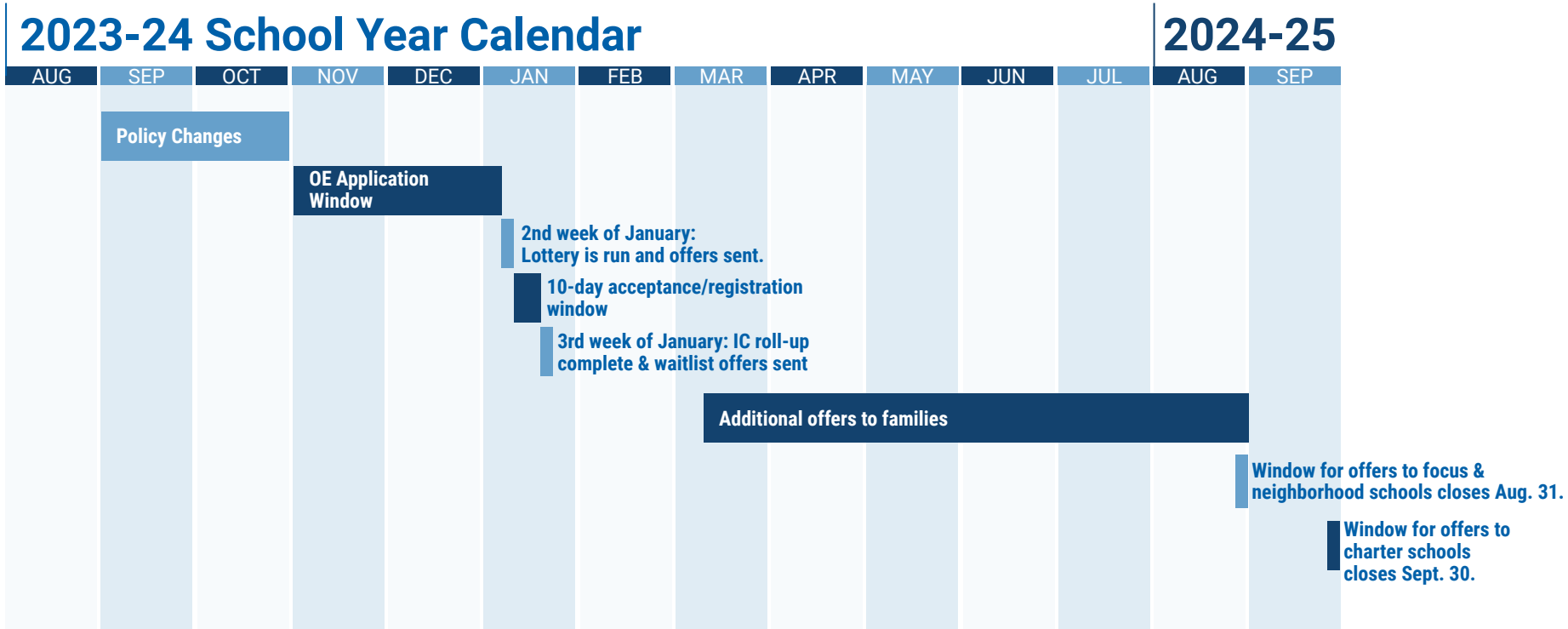
The Board of Education supports a variety of high quality educational programs. Students may attend their district designated neighborhood school (based on home address), or application may be made for open enrollment to another neighborhood school, a focus school (meets BVSD standards but may have a different curriculum or philosophy), or a charter school (an independent school within the district) in our school district.

GENERAL INFORMATION

- Before completing the open enrollment process, parents/guardians should obtain information about the school to which they are applying so that they are informed about the program. Opportunities to visit and observe schools may be scheduled by contacting individual school offices.
- Approval of open enrollment is based on available space, programming, and staffing at the requested school. Some schools/grade levels may have no spaces to offer. When the number of applicants exceeds the number of spaces available, students will be selected by a random selection lottery.
- When a student has been enrolled in any school under the open enrollment policy, that school becomes the “school of attendance” through the highest grade offered at the school. To return to the district neighborhood school, an Open Enrollment application must be submitted during the Open Enrollment period for the following year. Approval will be granted if there is space available.

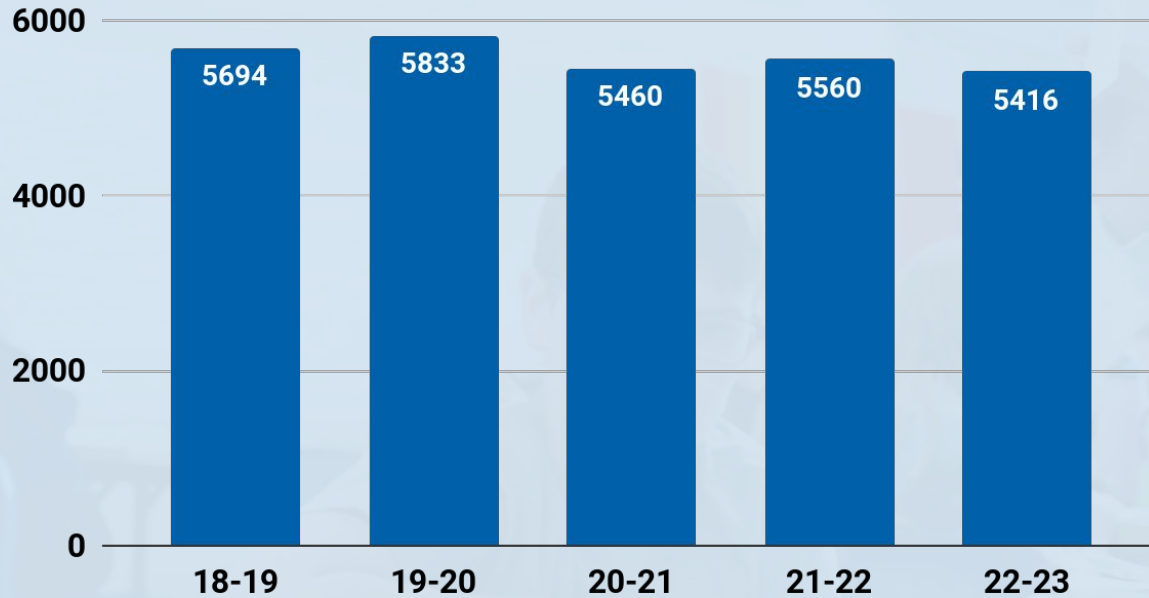


Timeline of OE Application Process



Trends Over Time

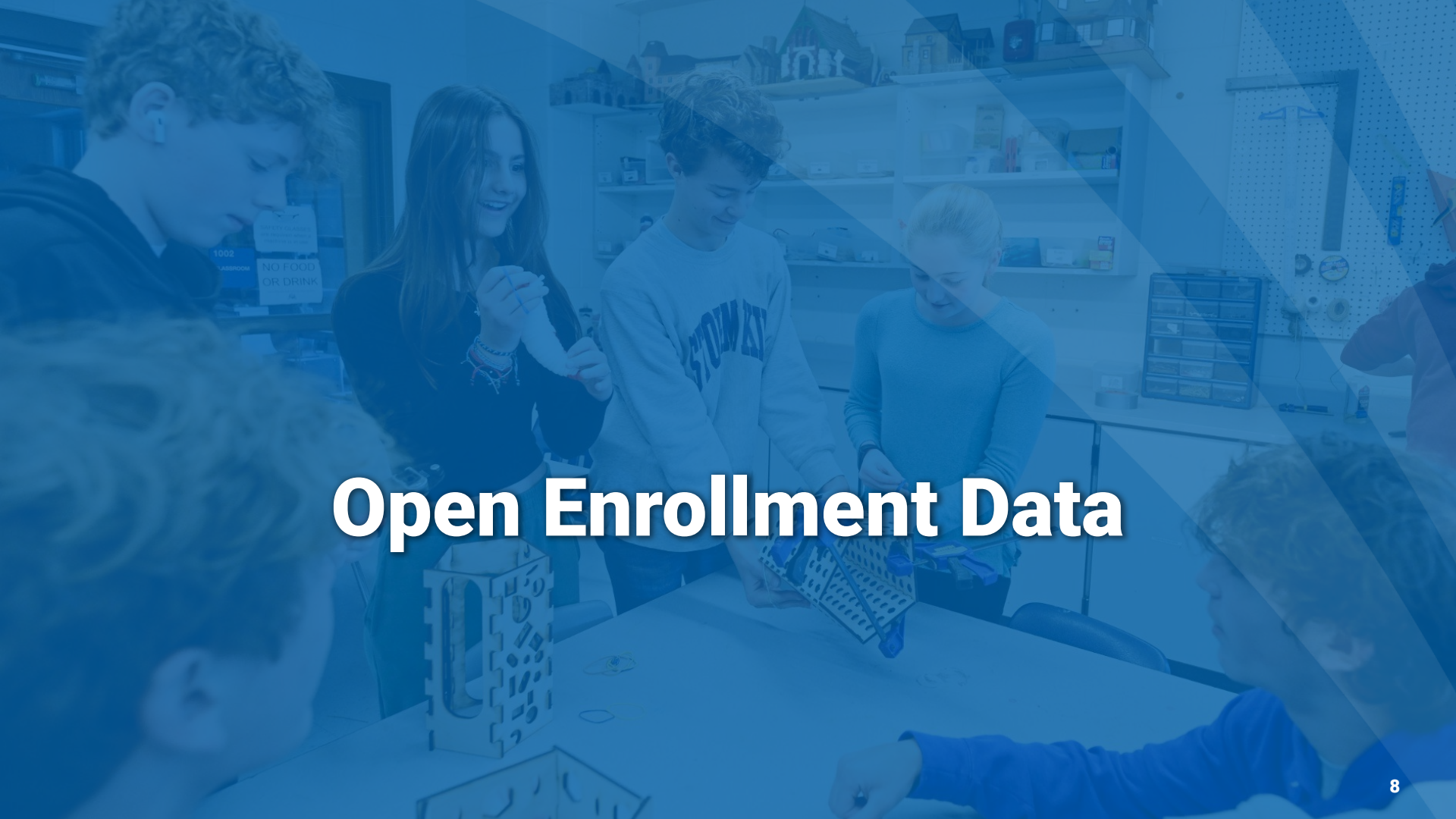
Applications for Open Enrollment Past 5 Years



Trends Over Time

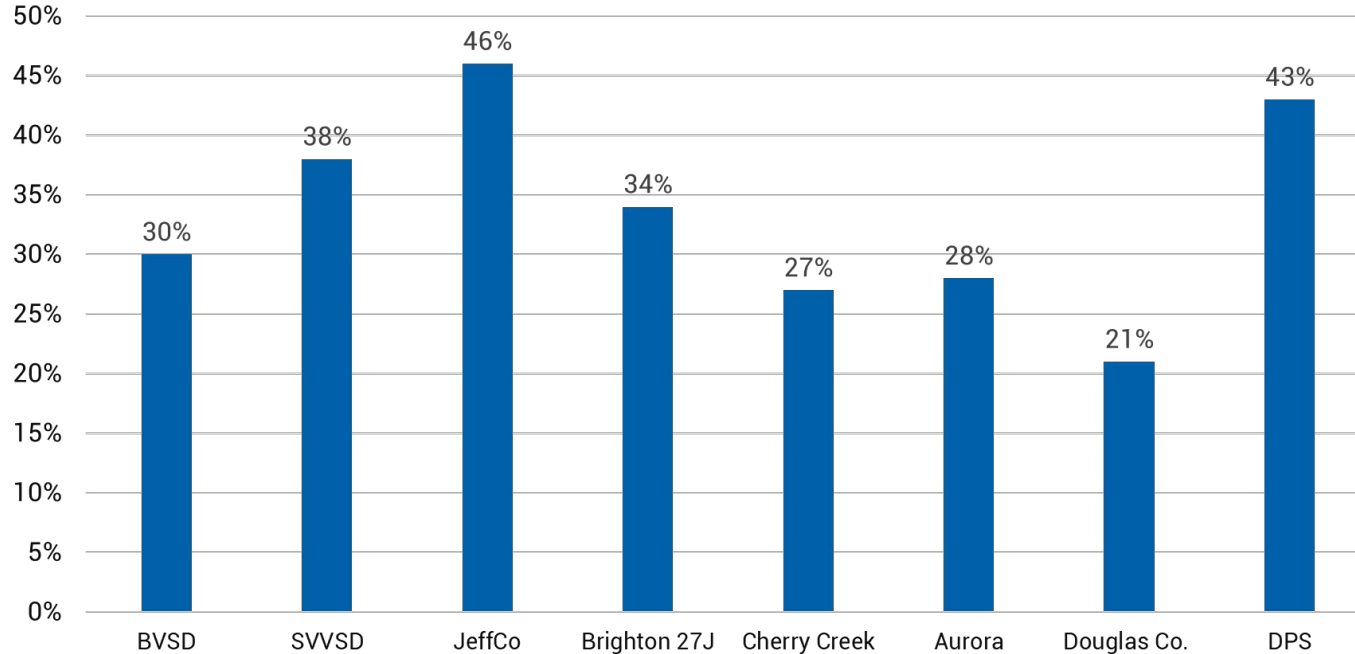
- With declining enrollment, families now have a much higher likelihood of being offered space at a school they applied to
- Last year, most schools' wait lists were "wiped clean"
- For the last 2 years, 1st choice seats were offered to all in-district families with on-time OE applications, except for charter schools and the few schools with space or programmatic limitations
- Many schools that used to experience long waitlists either have no waitlists now or are able to accommodate all students who apply through OE



A blue-tinted photograph of a group of students in a classroom or workshop. They are gathered around a table, focused on building structures using large, perforated blocks. In the background, there are shelves with various items, including model houses and a sign that reads "NO FOOD OR DRINK". The overall atmosphere is one of collaborative learning and hands-on activity.

Open Enrollment Data

Not Attending Neigh. School by District 2022-23



Note: Due to differences in methodology, there may be small variations between participation rates between districts.



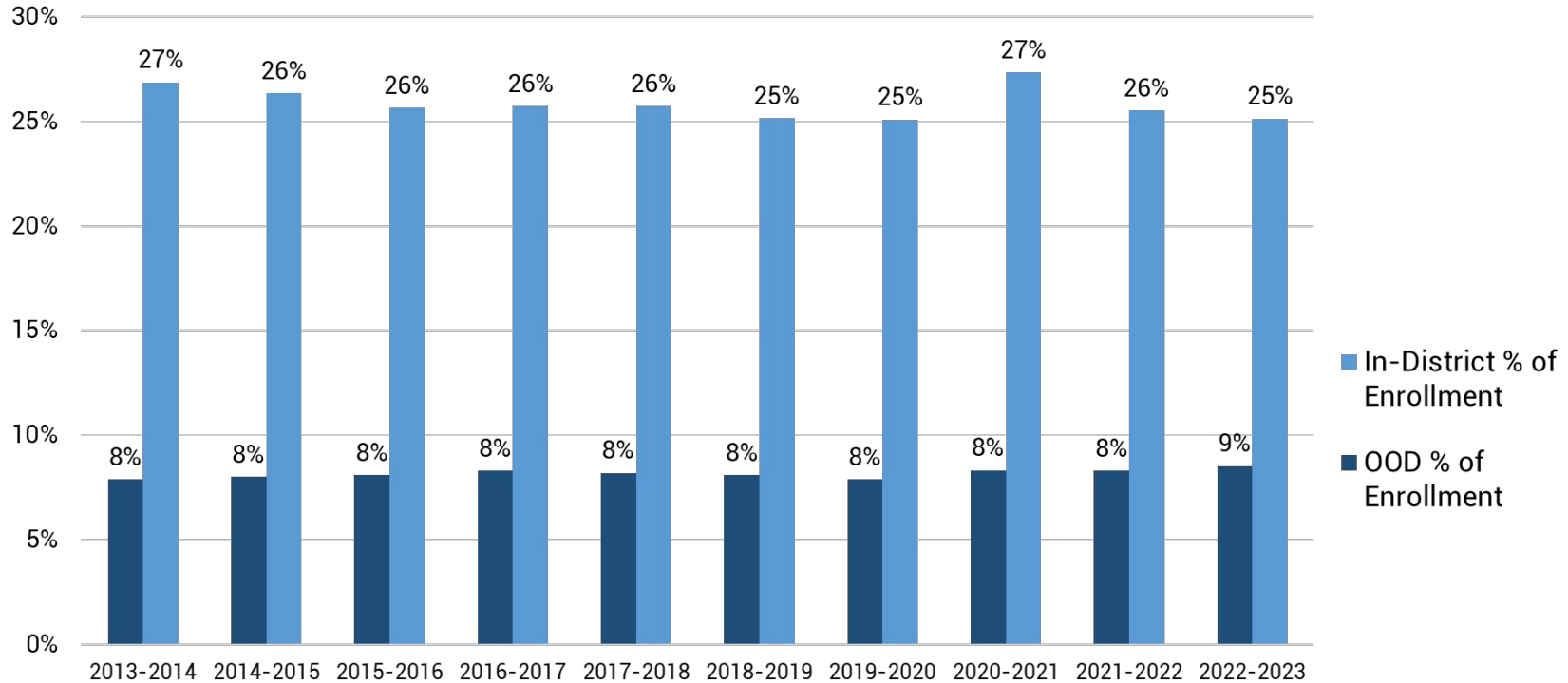
Open Enrollment Matrices

BVSD's Planning office tracks open enrollment data annually and publishes it by school level in the open enrollment matrices. The following charts illustrate some highlights of that data.

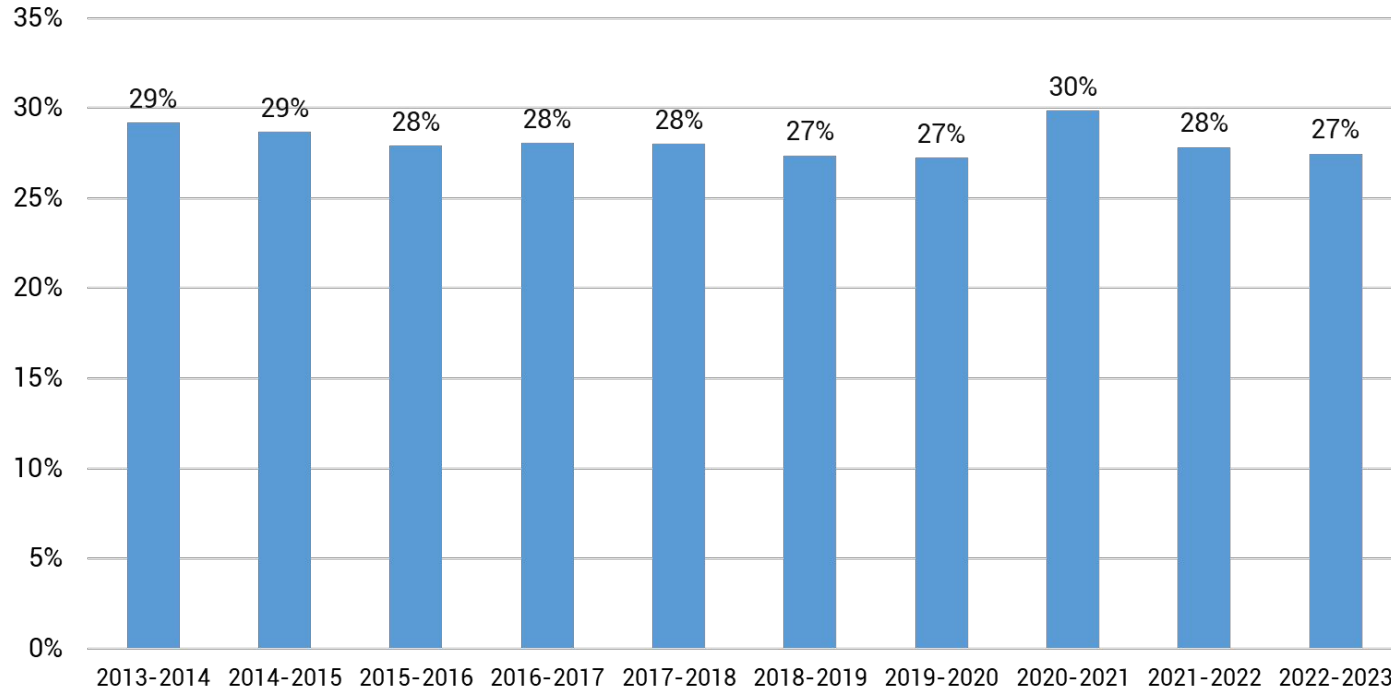
ENROLLMENT PATTERN MATRIX, 2022-2023 HIGH SCHOOL, 9-12																
School of Attendance	Neighborhood Attendance Area															
	Boulder*	Fairview*	Boulder/Fairview Optional	Broomfield	Centaurus	Monarch	Nederland	Attending Neighborhood School	Open Enrolled from within District	Open Enrolled from outside District	Placement Into School	Unmatched Addresses	Within BVSD Boundaries	Enrollment Total	% of Enrollment from Neighborhood Attendance Area	
Boulder	1764	84	119	1	26	14	14	Boulder	1883	139	14	15	8	2045	2059	91%
Fairview	210	1098	141	10	111	211	24	Fairview	1240	566	44	14	9	1829	1873	66%
Broomfield	1			858	9	4		Broomfield	858	14	750	2	3	877	1627	53%
Centaurus	7	20	2	14	1145	250		Centaurus	1145	293	44	14	12	1464	1508	76%
Monarch	6	8	2	22	117	1245	1	Monarch	1245	156	97	4	13	1418	1515	82%
Nederland	1			1			122	Nederland	122	2	4			124	128	95%
Arapahoe Ridge	44	17	1	12	46	19		Arapahoe Ridge	139	22	20			159	181	
Boulder Universal	20	7	3	16	15	17	1	Boulder Universal	79	37	8			87	124	
Halcyon	3	2			1	3		Halcyon	9		6			15	15	
New Vista	124	65	8	4	26	34	6	New Vista	267	38	4			271	309	
Boulder Prep	13	5	7	1	19	4		Boulder Prep	49	48	10	1		60	108	
Peak to Peak	15	8	5	71	253	103		Peak to Peak	455	138	2	1		458	596	
Justice High	12			4	32	6	1	Justice High	55	34	5			60	94	
Students Placed Out from Neighborhood Attendance Area	19	19	3	11	21	25	1		6493	2223	1270	104	47	8867	10137	64%
Total Number of Students living in Attendance Area	2239	1334	291	1024	1822	1935	170		64%	22%	13%					
Open Enrollment out of Attendance Area	456	216	28	155	656	665	47									
% of Students living in Attendance Area that are enrolled in Neighborhood School	79%	82%	89%	84%	63%	64%	72%									

* Note optional enrollment areas excluded.

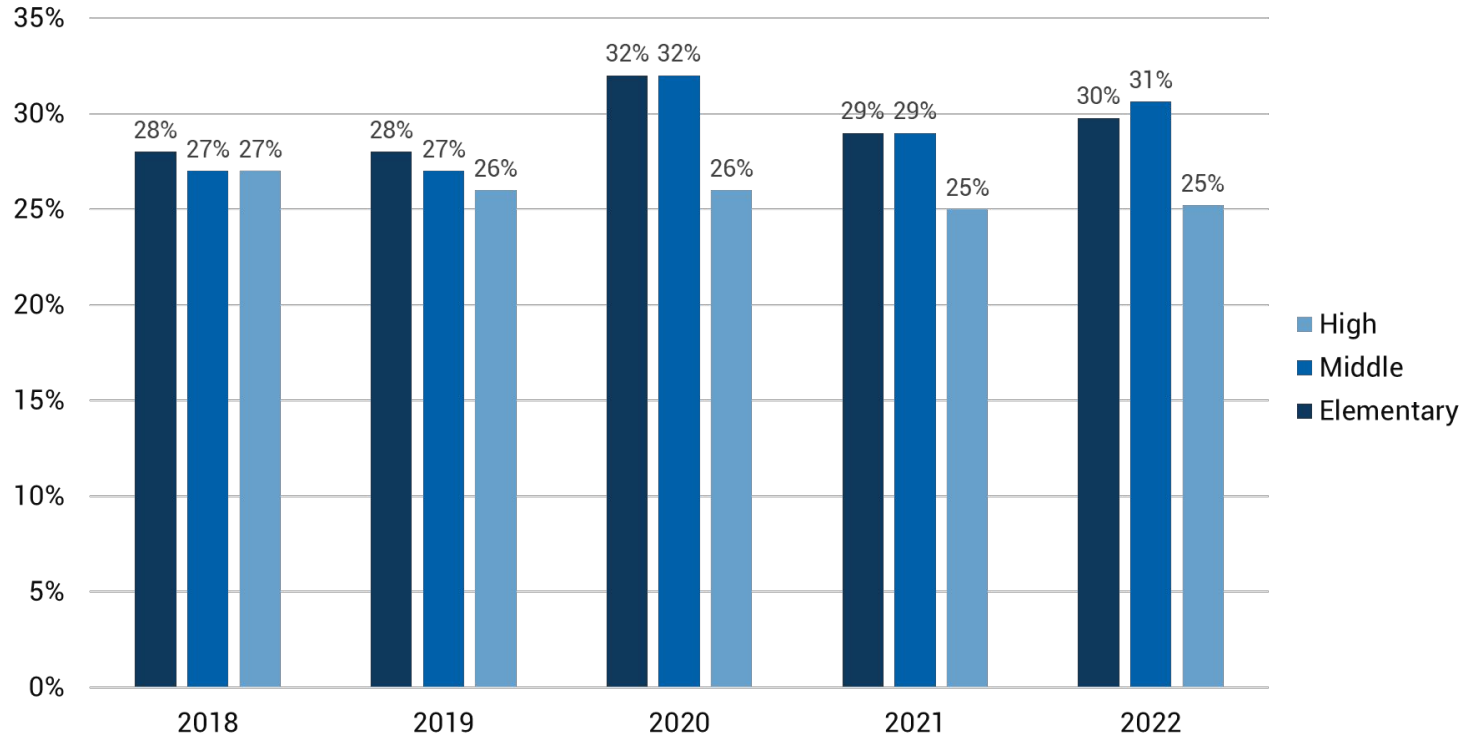
BVSD OE% of Enrollment 2013-22



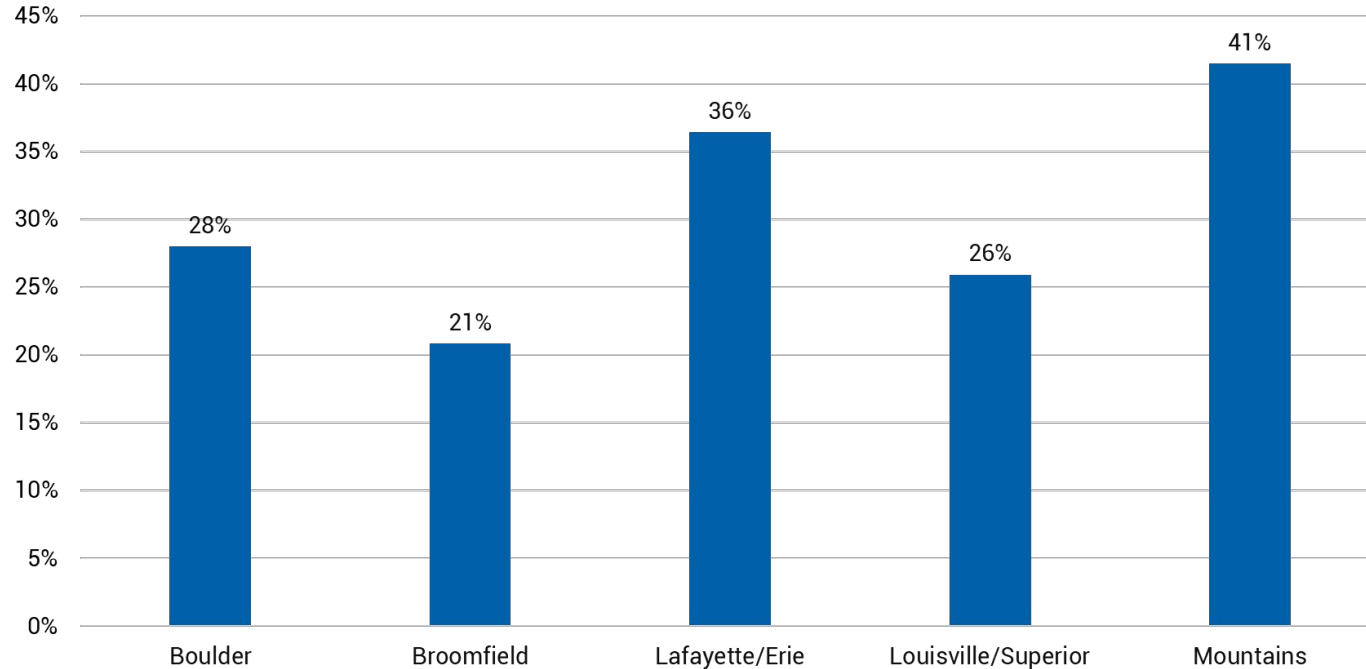
BVSD OE Resident K-12 Participation 2013-22



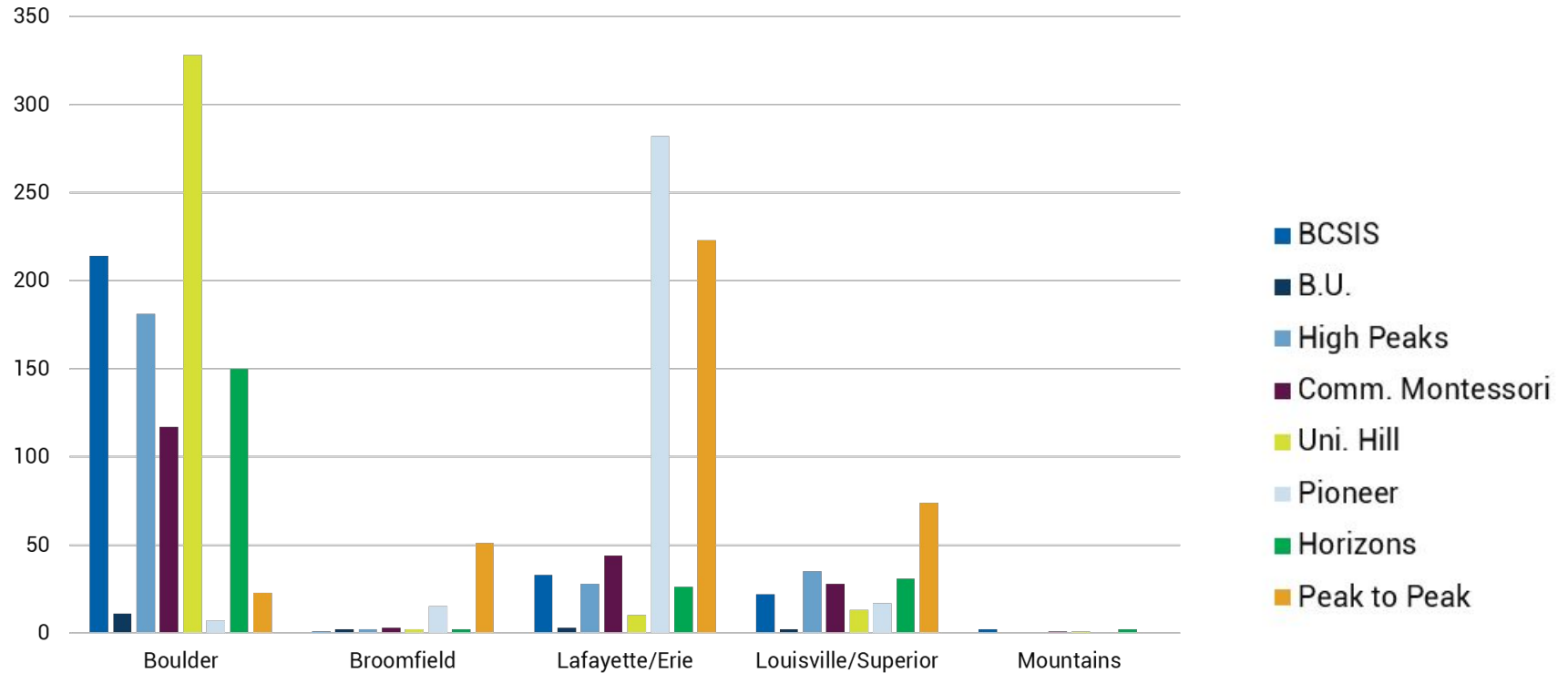
OE Resident Participation by Grade Level



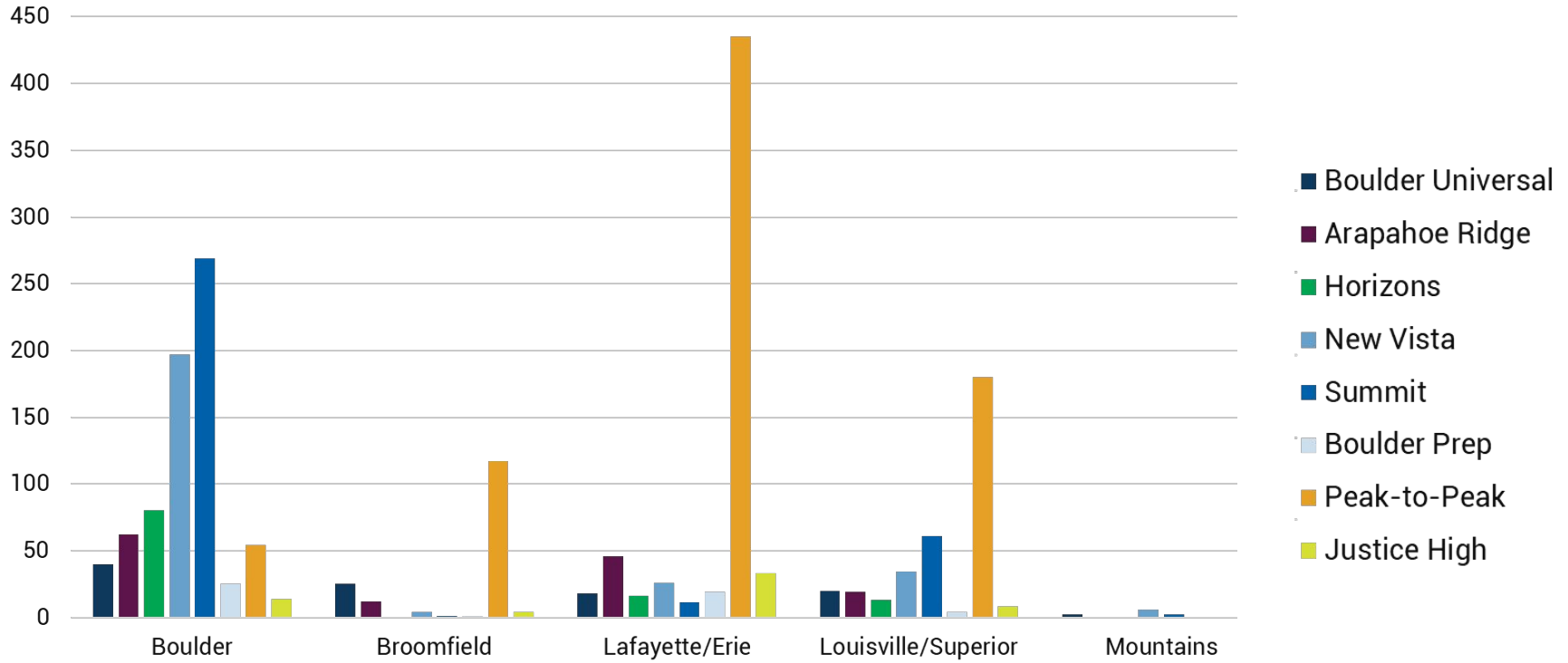
OE Resident K-12 Participation By Community



Elementary Focus-Charter Residency

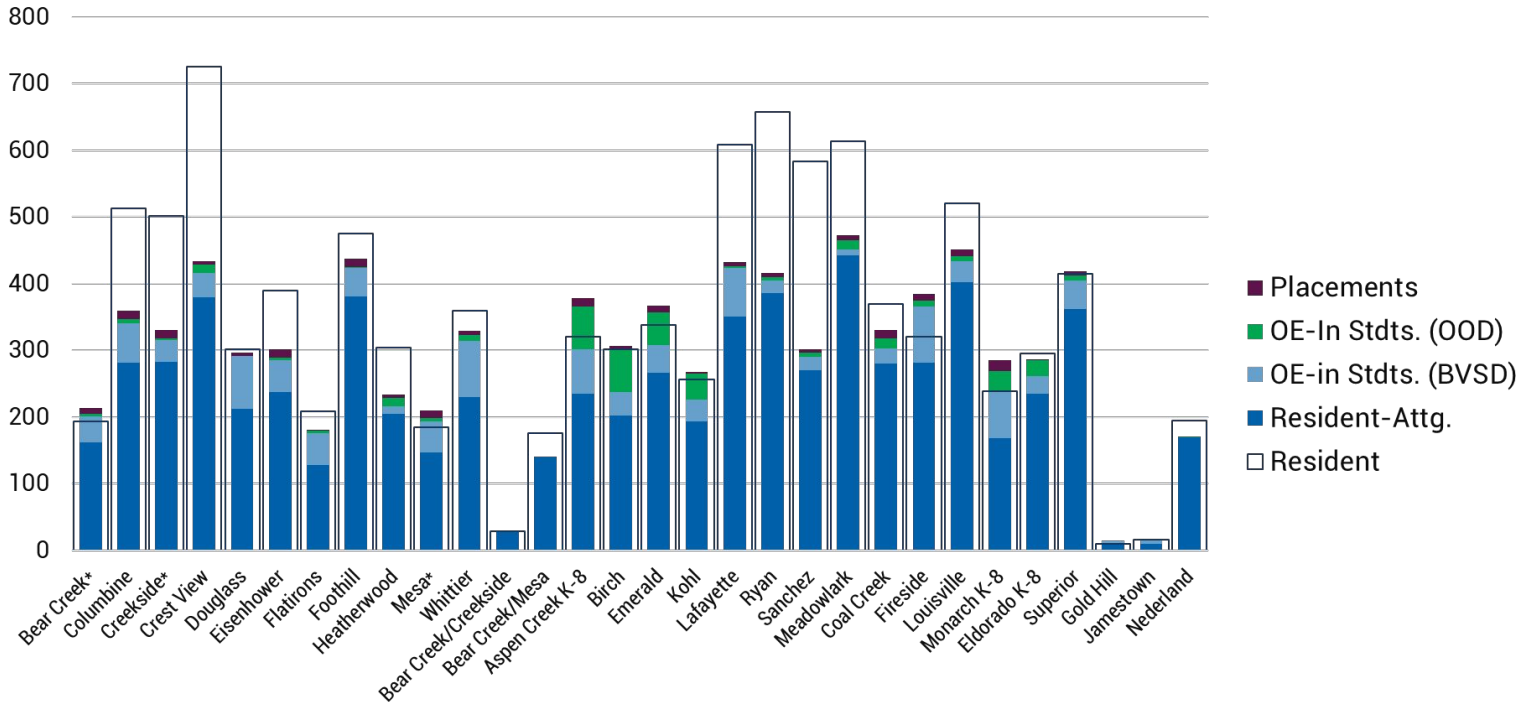


Secondary Focus-Charter Residency

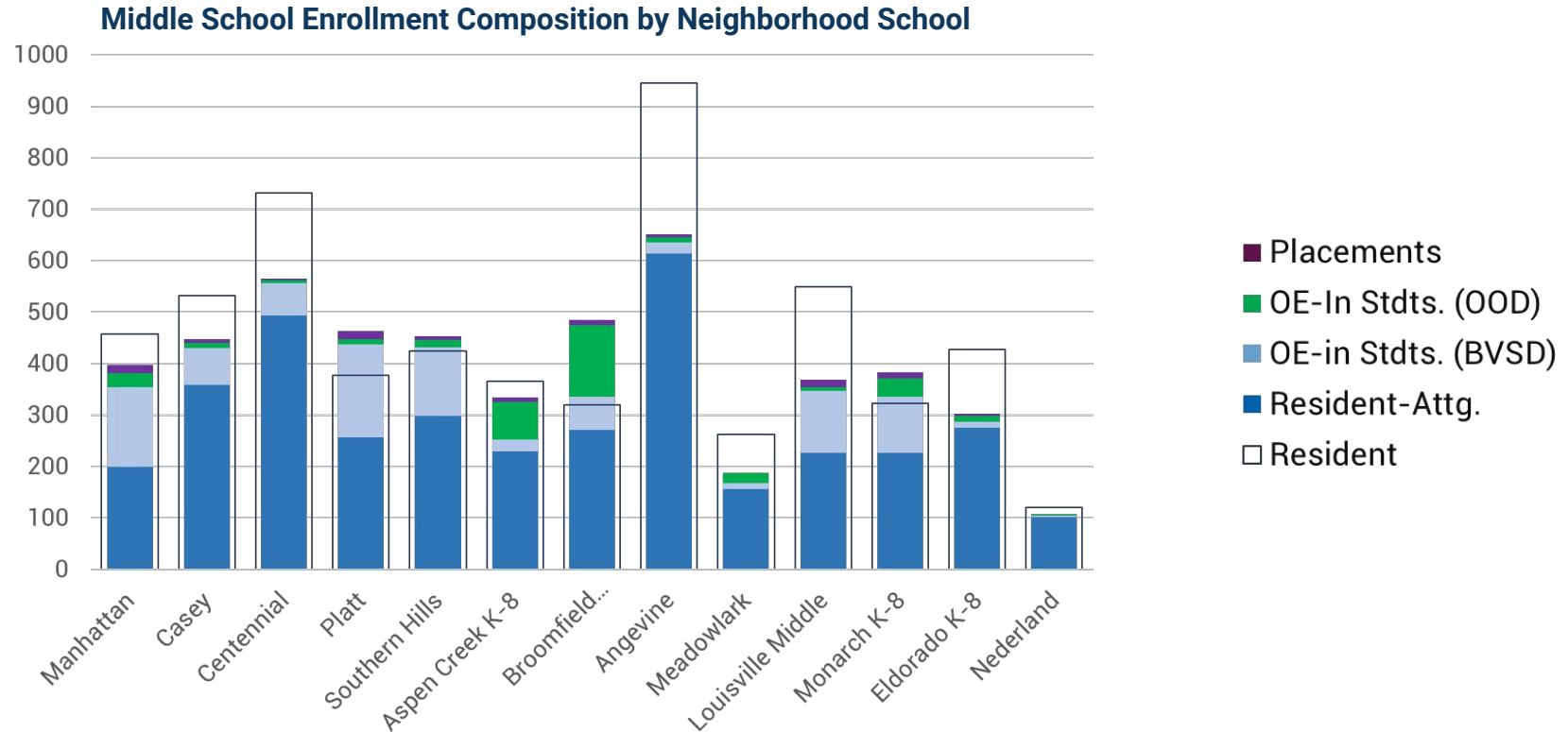


Elementary Enrollment Composition

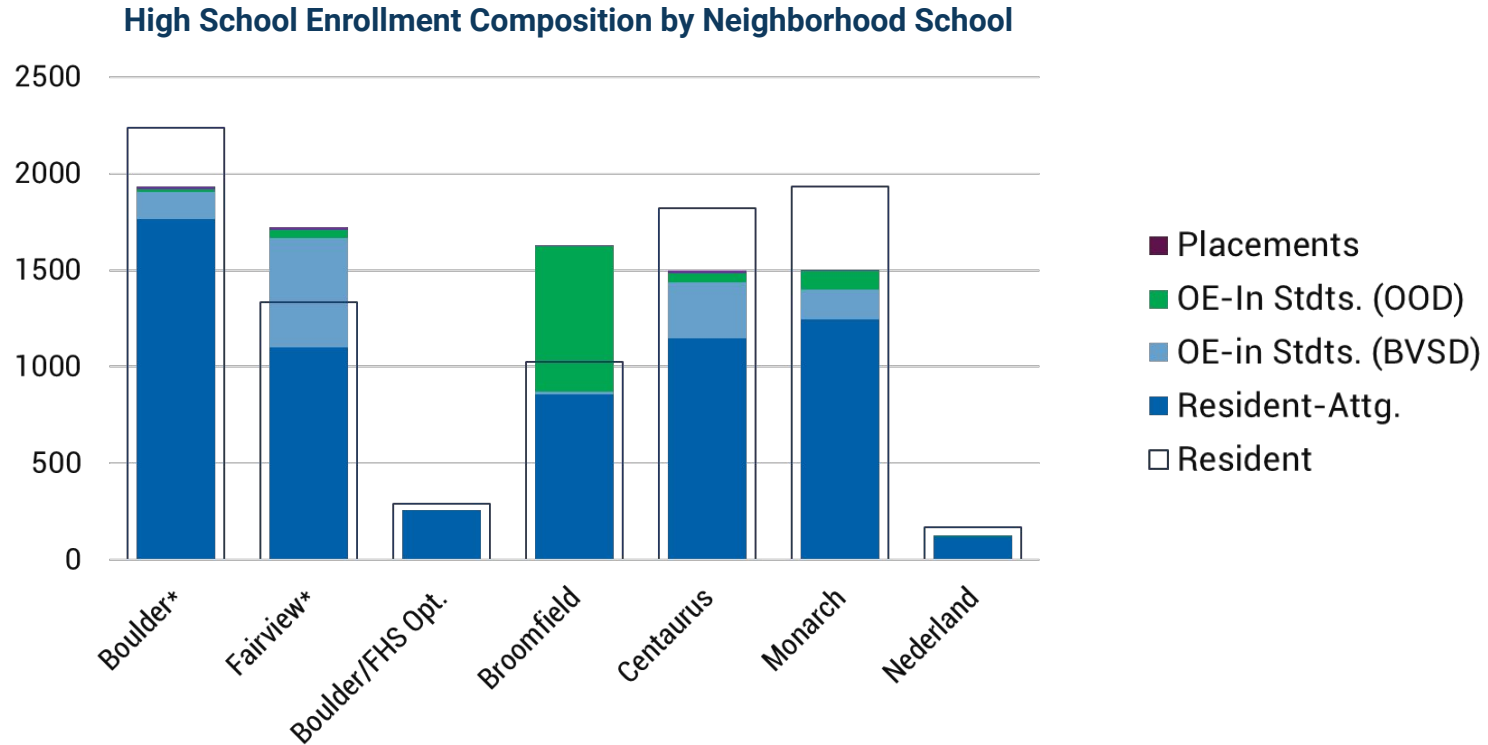
Elementary Enrollment Composition by Neighborhood School



Middle School Enrollment Composition



High School Enrollment Composition



Board Open Enrollment Policy

[JECC](#), Assignment of Students to Schools (1991)

Proposed Revisions (from April 2023 Board work session):

- Create/move substantive policy objectives to JECC
- Eliminate redundancies
- Eliminate legacy preference criteria
- Recode to JECC-R-2, Administrative Transfer (from JECE-R)



BVSD Policy JECC-R Open Enrollment

It has been practice to update this regulation annually.

In November 2022, BVSD updated this regulation to simplify the language, to reflect changes in the law (such as the State's universal preschool program and changes to the Exceptional Children's Education Act Rules), and to incorporate changes necessitated by the school district's new enrollment software system.

How OE Works in Other Districts

Cherry Creek: Updated policy and regulation in 2023 to the CASB sample

DPS: Defines “right-to-attend” schools, geographical catchment, and enrollment zones

Jeffco: Window in December or January; recently revised with preferences

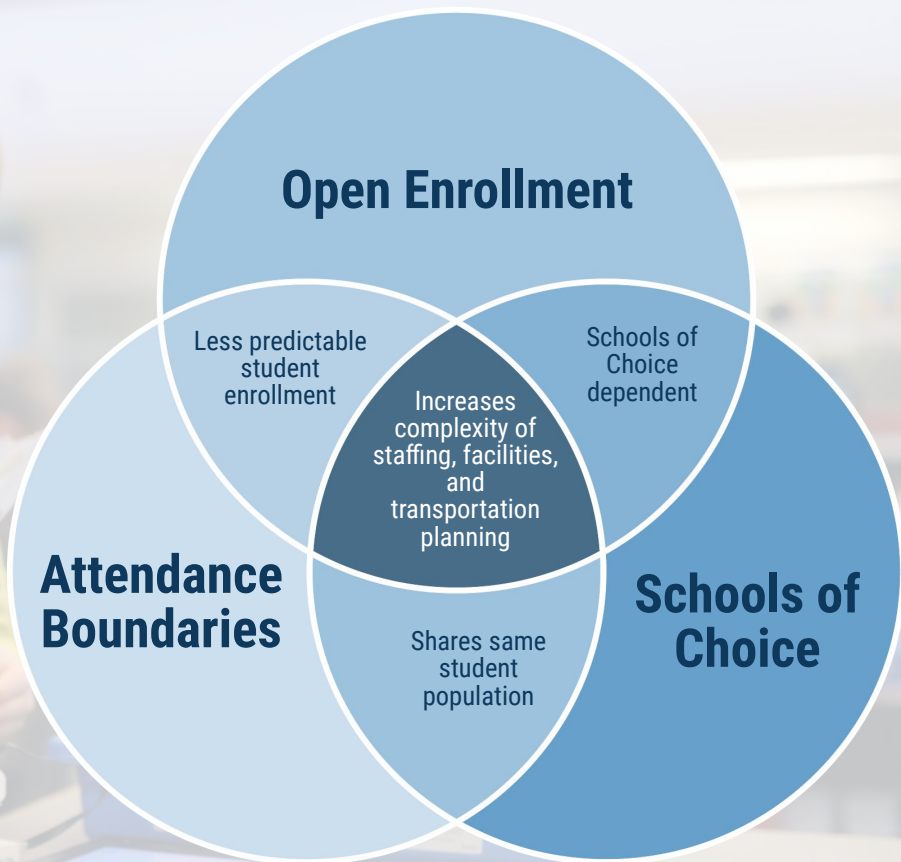
St Vrain: Special permission required to enroll after 10/1; Window open 12/1-12/15, receive offers by January 8; Granted for 1 year only

Thompson: District wide preferences; Notice by end of January



Considerations for OE Policy

- Requirements of law to create opportunities for in and out of district students
- Balancing enrollment of students at schools across the district
- Encourage out of district enrollment
- Interplay with JC, Attendance Boundaries, and IFF, Schools of Choice



Board Enrollment Discussions

Oct. 10: Enrollment Survey Data

Oct. 17: School Attendance Areas Policy JC

Oct. 24: Open Enrollment Policy JECC & JECC-R

Nov. 14: Schools of Choice Policy IFF